

Missed-call text-back

How the system is actually built, how it got approved, and what it takes to stand one up for a paying client.

Internal. Isaiah and Claude. Written 23 September 2026, the day the loop was proven end to end on Isaiah's own line.

What it does

A call comes in. If nobody answers, the caller hears Isaiah's recorded greeting and then receives a text a few seconds later. If they text back, that reply is forwarded to Isaiah's cell with the sender's number attached, so he can answer as himself. One Twilio Studio flow drives all of it, on both the voice leg and the messaging leg.

The build, as it exists today

Piece	Value
Twilio account	"My First Twilio Account" under isaiahsmith0007@gmail.com
Business number	+1 678-841-8081, friendly name ISF Business Line, Atlanta GA, local, SMS and MMS
Studio flow	Named Texter , FW65cdec62bde17db6ec0bd147ec22f9a1, Published
Messaging Service	MG36710eff1a00ebe2f5aebcc230dbd456, created 17 Aug 2026
10DLC campaign	CM8d01af68c7d735fcd0ce6a19e4a8b5a7, status Verified, sole proprietor use case
Brand	BN0541c12b1c53dee364435f9744b74dde, registered as SmithWebHQ, sole proprietor

The same flow SID is set on the number's voice configuration and its messaging configuration, and on the call status change webhook. That is why one flow can answer both a call and a text.

Widgets inside the Texter flow

Trigger fires on Message, Voice, Conversation, REST API or Subflow.

screen_ring is a TwiML redirect to a handler.twilio.com bin with a long timeout, and **ring_isaiah** is a Connect Call To pointed at +1 940-595-2795. That pair is what tries Isaiah before anything automatic happens.

did_isaiah_answer splits on the dial status coming out of screen_ring, with branches for a short call and for no duration. That split is the definition of "missed."

greet_caller plays an audio file hosted at isaiahsmithfilms.com/media/, not Twilio text to speech. On Audio Complete it hands off to **text_the_caller**, a Send Message carrying the "Got your call" wording.

forward_reply is the messaging leg. It sends "Reply from {{trigger.message.From}}: {{trigger.message.Body}}" to Isaiah's cell, which is why a text sent from that same cell comes back looking like an echo.

Read this before touching anything. The greeting is a file on Isaiah's own website. If that file is renamed, moved or lost in a redeploy, the greeting silently stops playing and callers get dead air before the text. Any client build should host their greeting somewhere that is not going to be redesigned out from under it.

The registration is the whole job

Building the flow took an afternoon. Getting the carriers to accept the texts took twelve days and two rejections. That ratio is the thing to price and schedule around, and it is the part a client cannot do themselves.

The evidence

The messaging log is the cleanest proof of what registration does. Same two numbers, same flow, before and after approval:

When	Direction and result
11 Sep, 13 Sep	Outbound, Undelivered , four attempts. Inbound was fine throughout.
16 Sep	Campaign approved, email from a2p10dlc@twilio.com
23 Sep	Inbound Received, outbound Delivered one second later

If a client build ever shows outbound Undelivered while inbound is Received, the problem is registration, not the flow. Do not debug the flow.

What the reviewers rejected, and what they accepted

Rejected on 14 September for two reasons: the opt-in link showed no consent language, and two opt-in methods were ticked while only one was described.

Approved on 16 September after all of this was true at once:

- A real terms page live on the business's own domain, reachable and readable, with message type, frequency, "message and data rates may apply" and STOP instructions on it.
- A visible note next to the published phone number saying the number can be texted.
- The rates and STOP line carried inside the first text itself, not only on the website.
- An opt-in description covering every method ticked. Two boxes means two described paths: the customer calls first, and the customer texts first.
- Terms and privacy links pointing at the same domain the campaign describes.

The mistake that cost the first rejection was pointing the campaign at one entity while the terms pages lived on another. Whatever the brand is registered as, the campaign's description, its links and the site the customer actually lands on all have to tell one story.

Standing one up for a client

In order. Registration is slow, so start it the day the client says yes and build while it sits in review.

Step	Detail
Accounts first	Twilio account created under the client's own entity and billing, Isaiah added as admin. This follows the handoff rule: nothing important lives in Isaiah's personal accounts.
Settle the number	One of the three routes on the client sheet. This decides everything downstream, so settle it before provisioning.
Terms page	A real page on the client's domain, not a copy on Isaiah's. Model it on isaiahsmithfilms.com/sms-terms .
Text-me note	Next to the number wherever it is published: site, Google Business Profile, footer.
Brand and campaign	Submit with the description and sample texts matching the client's real wording and the client's real site. Expect a rejection and budget a resubmission.
Build the flow	Clone the Texter structure. Change the forward target, the greeting audio and the message bodies. Keep the rates and STOP line in the first text.
Attach and publish	Number into the Messaging Service, flow SID onto both the voice and messaging config, publish the flow.
Prove it	Have someone who is not the client and not Isaiah call the line and let it ring out. Check the log reads Delivered, not just that a text arrived.

The three number routes, technically

Route	What it means for the build
New number	Simplest. Provision, register, done. Everything lives in one place and the whole loop runs on one number. The friction is commercial, not technical: the client has to republish the number everywhere.
Keep their number	Their carrier's busy or no-answer forwarding points at the Twilio number. The flow never sees the answered calls, which is fine. The honest limitation is that the text-back originates from the Twilio number, so the customer sees a number they did not dial. Say this out loud in the sales conversation.
Port the number	Best experience, most exposure. Their main business line moves into an account Isaiah set up, so the account-under-the-client's-entity rule stops being a nicety and becomes the thing that keeps this from being a hostage situation. Plan the cutover, and do not port for a client who might rebrand.

What this costs to run

Deliberately not listing figures here, because Twilio's rates and the 10DLC fees change and a stale number in a runbook is worse than no number. The recurring items to look up before quoting are: the monthly rental on each

phone number, the per-segment price on messages in and out, the one-time brand registration fee, and the monthly campaign fee. Note that a message over 160 characters bills as more than one segment, so the wording of the first text has a running cost attached to it.

Still open

- **Pricing.** Undecided. Nothing anywhere in this project is a price Isaiah has agreed to. The client sheet carries no figures on purpose.
- **What happens on the client's side after hours.** Right now the forward target is one cell. A shop with staff may need the reply to reach more than one phone, which is a flow change, not a setting.
- **Handling STOP.** Twilio honours STOP automatically at the carrier level, but nobody has tested what the client sees when a customer opts out mid-conversation.
- **Isaiah's own forward target** is still his Texas cell, +1 940-595-2795, while everything public now points at the Atlanta number. It works, but it is worth knowing that is where the calls land.